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Method For Cutting Curly Hair

Abstract

The methods disclosed herein are generally directed to method for cutting hair that create balance and volume. The methods include a C-, pinch-, and/or a rose-cut technique. Each technique includes separating the hair to be cut into a plurality of sections and further partitioning the section into subsections. The C-cut technique includes forming the hand of the stylist into a C-configuration around a subsection of hair and cutting the hair in a circular motion. The pinch-cut technique includes curling a plurality of fingers on the hand of the stylist in one direction, curling the thumb in the other direction, and overlapping the curled fingers and thumb. The hair held in the C-, pinch-configuration may then be cut in a circular motion such that hair positioned within a center of the subsection is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior of the portion of the hair.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0001] While hairstyles and methods of achieving these hairstyles have evolved over the years, curly hair has posed a challenge because of its need for balance while maintaining full body density and volume of the curls. Existing methods are commonly a one-size fits all approach. The typical hair cutting method is frequently based on fine or straight hair. Customarily, a haircut consists of the hairstylist lifting a portion of the client's hair, pulling the portion away from the client's head, and cutting the ends of the hair in a straight line while the ends are turned up, e.g., inverted towards the top of the client's head, as compared to the client's shoulders and elevated away from the client's head. The portioning of an individual's hair is often performed with the intention of cutting the ends of the individual's hair parallel to the horizontal axis of the floor. Trimming thick, textured, and/or curly hair in this typical manner can result in noticeable breaks in lengths, resembling shelves, between each layer of hair since the texture of curls does not allow each strand to integrate smoothly together.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0002] The methods disclosed herein are generally directed to method for cutting hair that create balance and volume. The methods include a C-cut technique, a pinch-cut technique, or a rose cut technique. Each technique may include separating the hair to be cut into a plurality of sections. Each section may be further partitioned into subsection. The C-cut technique may include forming the hand of the stylist into a C-configuration around a subsection of hair. The C-configuration minimizes the tension in the hand of the stylist while having a loose hold of the ends of the hair. The hair within the C-configuration may be cut or trimmed in a circular motion corresponding to the circular shape formed by the C-configuration. The pinch-cut technique may include curling a plurality of fingers on the hand of the stylist in one direction, e.g., towards the thumb, and curling the thumb in the other direction, e.g., towards the fingers, thereby creating an overlap between the fingers and the thumb. The pinch configuration maximizes the tension in the hand while maintaining a tight hold of the ends of the hair. The hair held in the pinch configuration may then be cut in a circular motion such that hair positioned within the center of the hair being held is cut shorter than hair positioned close to the hair closest to the fingers and thumb of the stylist. The rose cut technique may be used with the C-cut technique and/or the pinch-cut technique. Each cut of hair during the circular motion of the C-cut technique and/or pinch-cut technique may be done with the cutting device angled inwardly such that triangular shaped portions of hair are cut.

[0003] The present disclosure is to a method for cutting hair by a hairstylist in order to create balance and volume. The method may comprise separating hair of an individual into a plurality of sections of hair. The hair of the individual covers at least a portion of a head of the individual. The head has a top with a crown, a right side, a left side, and a back side extending along an occipital bone. The method may further comprise securing the plurality of sections with at least one fastener and cutting the hair within each of the plurality of sections using a C-cut technique. The C-cut technique may comprise removing the at least one fastener from one of the plurality of sections, thereby releasing the hair within the one of the plurality of sections, holding, within a first hand of the hairstylist formed in a "C" shape, a portion of the hair within the one of the plurality of sections, such that ends of the portion of the hair extend through an opening created by the first hand, cutting, by the hairstylist using a cutting implement held in a second hand, the ends of the portion of the hair extending through the opening in a circular motion such that hair positioned within a center of the portion of the hair is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior of the portion of the hair, and repeating the removing, holding, and cutting steps until all of the hair within the one of the plurality of sections is cut.

[0004] The method may further include sectioning of the hair. The sections of hair may vary. For example, the plurality of sections may comprise four sections. A first section of the four sections may be located on the crown, the second section of the four sections may be located on the right side, a third section of the four sections may be located on the left side, and a fourth section of the four sections may be located on the back side extending along the occipital bone. A length of hair cut from the hair within the fourth section may be greater than a length of hair cut from the hair within the first section. The hair from each of the four sections may be cut to a respective length to create a layered effect between the sections. The method may further comprise selecting an initial section of the plurality of sections, wherein the initial section is the fourth section. In some examples, the plurality of sections may comprise six sections. The hair may be in a dry condition prior to cutting.

[0005] The “C” shape of the first hand of the hairstylist may comprise holding the first hand away from a body associated with the hair and parallel to a horizontal axis, grasping a portion of hair with the first hand, slightly flexing a thumb of the first hand in an upward motion relevant to the horizontal axis, slightly flexing an index finger of the first hand in a downward motion relevant to the horizontal axis, orienting the index finger towards the upturned thumb, such that the index finger does not make contact with the thumb and an opening is positioned between the index finger and the thumb, and slightly flexing a plurality of remaining fingers in an orientation mimicking the position of the index finger. The method may further include holding the portion of the hair such that the ends of the portion of the hair that extend through the opening are held without pressure being applied to the portion of hair by the first hand of the hairstylist.

[0006] Another aspect of the disclosure is directed to a method for cutting hair by a hairstylist in order to create balance and volume. The method comprises separating hair of an individual into a plurality of sections of hair, wherein the hair of the individual covers a head of the individual, the head having a top with a crown, a right side, a left side, and a back side extending along an occipital bone, securing the hair within each of the sections with at least one fastener, and cutting the hair within each of the sections using a pinch method. The pinch method may comprise removing the fasteners from one of the sections, thereby releasing the hair within the one of the plurality of sections, pinching, within a first hand of the hairstylist, a portion of hair within the one of the sections, adjusting a position of the first hand so that it is located near ends of the hair, cutting, by the hairstylist using a cutting implement held in a second hand, the ends of the hair extending through the first hand in a circular motion such that hair positioned within a center of the portion of the hair is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior of the portion of the hair, and repeating that steps until all of the hair is cut.

[0007] The method may further include sectioning of the hair. The sections of hair may vary. For example, the plurality of sections may comprise four sections. A first section of the four sections may be located on the crown, the second section of the four sections may be located on the right side, a third section of the four sections may be located on the left side, and a fourth section of the four sections may be located on the back side extending along the occipital bone. A length of hair cut from the hair within the fourth section may be greater than a length of hair cut from the hair within the first section. The hair from each of the four sections may be cut to a respective length to create a layered effect between the sections. Further, the method may comprise selecting an initial section of the plurality of sections, wherein the initial section is the fourth section. The plurality of sections may comprise four sections. The hair may be in a dry condition prior to cutting.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0008] FIG. 1 is a back view of the partially sectioned hair secured by one fastener according to

aspects of the disclosure.

[0009] FIG. 2 is a side profile view of the sectioned hair secured by two fasteners according to aspects of the disclosure.

[0010] FIG. 3 is a back view of four sections of hair, secured by four fasteners according to aspects of the disclosure.

[0011] FIG. 4 is a back view of the sectioned hair secured by three fasteners, once at least one section has been released from its fastener according to aspects of the disclosure.

[0012] FIG. 5 is a top view of a head showing six section divisions in which hair may be portioned and secured.

[0013] FIG. 6 is a back view of a head showing six horizontal sections in which hair may be portioned and secured.

[0014] FIG. 7 is a side profile view of the position of a hand in a C-configuration according to aspects of the description.

[0015] FIG. 8 is a side profile view of the position of a hand in a C-configuration with at least one portion of a section of hair cupped within the hand according to aspects of the description, in which the head of the client is not shown.

[0016] FIG. 9 is a side profile view of the position of a hand in a C-configuration with at least one portion of a section of hair cupped within the hand, in which the head of the client is not shown, with indicators for direction of cutting according to aspects of the description.

[0017] FIG. 10 is a side profile view of the position of a hand with pinched fingers according to aspects of the description.

[0018] FIG. 11 is a side profile view of the position of a hand with pinched fingers holding at least one portion of a section of hair according to aspects of the description, in which the head of the client is not shown.

[0019] FIG. 12 is a side profile view of the position of a hand with pinched fingers holding at least one portion of a section of hair, in which the head of the client is not shown, with indicators for direction of cutting according to aspects of the description.

[0020] FIG. 13A is a flow chart for an example method of utilizing the C-cut technique to cut hair.

[0021] FIG. 13B is a flow chart for an example method of utilizing the pinch cut technique to cut hair.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0022] As used herein in reference to the anatomy of the client, the term “superior” refers to a location nearer the crown or apex of the client's head while the term “inferior” refers to a location nearer the client's occipital bone. As with the terms “superior” and “inferior,” the term “anterior” refers to a location nearer the front of the client, the term “posterior” refers to a location nearer the rear or back of the client, the term “medial” refers to a location nearer the mid-line of the client, and the term “lateral” refers to a location farther away from the mid-line of the client. Additionally, as used herein, the terms “about,” “approximately,” “generally,” and “substantially” are intended to mean that slight deviations from absolute are included within the scope of the term so modified.

[0023] The present disclosure relates to a method for cutting hair based on the attributes associated with the hair. The attributes may include, for example, the texture, thickness, and/or type. The hair type may include, for example, straight, wavy, curly, kinky, etc. The method of cutting the hair may use a C-cut technique. The C-cut technique follows the texture of the hair by utilizing a circular cutting motion that compliments the natural direction of the ends of the hair. The ends of the hair may be, for example, the loose ends of the hair not attached to the scalp. The stylist may position a hand into a C-configuration. Sections of hair are lightly cupped within the positioned hand, and a cutting implement is directed to follow a circular motion while trimming the ends of the hair. The circular motion of the cutting implement may correspond to the C-configuration, e.g., circular configuration, of the hand cupping the hair. By cupping the sections of hair in the hand forming a

C-configuration and using a circular motion with the cutting instrument, the cut hair may include smoothly integrated layers, allowing the hair to have balanced body and shape. Further, by using a C-configuration to cup the hair and a circular motion with the cutting implement, the C-cut technique does not assume that the ends of the hair naturally fall parallel to a horizontal axis. This allows for the C-cut technique to better highlight the natural shape, texture, thickness, and type. [0024] FIG. 1 illustrates an example of the plurality of sections of hair on the head of a client. For example, the C-cut technique may be performed iteratively on sections of hair. The stylist may separate the hair **108** on the head **100** of the client into the plurality of sections. As shown in FIG. 1, there may be four sections. While FIG. 1 and the description herein refers to four sections, there may be any number of sections such that four sections is just one example and is not intended to be limiting. Further, while only one fastener is shown, there may be any number of fasteners such that one fastener per section is just one example and is not intended to be limiting.

[0025] As an example, if the hair is sectioned into four sections, an “X” may be visualized along the back of the head, using a superior tip of a right ear as a guide for the starting height of a first diagonal line and a superior tip of a left ear as a guide for the starting height of a second diagonal line. The diagonal lines extending from the superior tips of the left and right ear may cross in the center of the back of the head. The diagonal lines may delineate a portion at the crown or apex area of the head, a portion to the left, a portion to the right, and a portion along the occipital bone of the head.

[0026] FIGS. 2 and 3 are examples in which the hair has been sectioned. FIG. 3 is a back view that illustrates four sections of hair. In this regard, and referring to FIG. 3, the sections include a crown portion **110**, a left side portion **120**, a right side portion **130**, and a back portion **140**. The crown portion **110** is located at the apex of the head, at the top of a visualized “X,” beginning at the tips of the left ear and right ear, continuing down diagonally to meet at a point in the center of the back of the head. The back portion **140** is located along the occipital bone of the client's head, at the bottom of the visualized “X.” Section **120** is located between the crown portion **110** and the bottom portion **140**, along the left side of the head. Section **130** is located between the crown portion **110** and the bottom portion **140**, along the right side of the head.

[0027] FIG. 2 shows another view of sectioned hair. In particular, FIG. 2 is a side profile in which there are two sections of hair. Due to the perspective of FIG. 2, a left side section and a portion of the crown section are illustrated.

[0028] The sections of hair, as shown in FIGS. 2 and 3, may be secured using one or more fasteners. The number of fasteners shown in FIGS. 2 and 3 are exemplary and are not intended to be limiting.

[0029] While FIGS. 2 and 3 illustrate sections based on an “X”, the sections may be sectioned based on a visualized “t” such that a horizontal division spans from the superior tips of the left ear to the right ear, and a vertical division is located along the center of the client's head, spanning from the crown or apex to the base of the occipital bone. Accordingly, the visualized “X” for sectioning the four sections is just one example and is not intended to be limiting.

[0030] According to some examples, the sections may have a substantially triangular shape. In some examples, the sections may have a shape substantially similar to a kite, trapezoid, quadrilateral, or the like. In some examples, one of the sections may have a first type of shape, another section may have another type of shape, or the like. Accordingly, the shapes of any one section may be the same or different than another section.

[0031] The hair in each section may be secured. For example, a fastener **10** may be used to secure the portions of hair **108** into sections. The fastener depicted in the figures is just one example and is not intended to be limiting. Fasteners may include but are not limited to sectioning clips, butterfly clips, crocodile or alligator clips, claw clips, bobby pins, barrettes, hair elastics, snap clips, and banana clips.

[0032] FIG. 5 illustrates an example of sectioning hair into six sections, instead of four sections.

The sections may consist of a front crown section **115**, left side crown section **125**, a right side crown section **135**, a back left section **143**, a back right section **145**, and a center crown section **150**. The center crown section **150** is oriented between the cars, the front crown section **115** is located proximal to the forehead and in front of the cars, the left side crown section **125** is located on the left side of the head between the front crown section **115** and the center crown section **150**, the right side crown section **135** is located on the right side of the head between the front crown section **115** and the center crown section **150**, the back left section **143** is located along the left side of the occipital bone, and the back right section **145** may be located along the right side of the occipital bone. References to left and right sides and/or sections may be based on the perspective of the user cutting the hair. In some examples, references to the left and right sides and/or section may be based on the perspective of the client's right hand and left hand. The sections may be secured using one or more fasteners. According to some examples, when creating the sections, the shape of the sections may be triangular, may have a shape substantially similar to a kite, trapezoid, quadrilateral, or the like. In some examples, one of the sections may have a first type of shape, another section may have another type of shape, or the like.

[0033] A variety of factors may be considered when choosing the number of sections selected to perform the method. For example, the number of sections may be based on the desired hairstyle of the client, the density of the client's hair, the texture of the client's hair, the length of the client's hair, and/or the thickness of the client's hair. For example, if a client has thick or dense hair, a greater number of sections may allow the stylist to more accurately trim all of the hair, as the size of the subsections may be customized. In some examples, if the client desires a lot of layers in their haircut, a greater number of sections may increase the layer effect of the C-cut technique.

[0034] FIG. **6** illustrates another example of sectioning hair. For example, the hair may be sectioned into a right, left, and back section. The back section may be further apportioned into a plurality of horizontal sections. While six horizontal sections are illustrated, the back section may be separated into any number of sections. According to some examples, the number of horizontal sections may be proportional to the amount of volume generated by the cut. For example, a greater number of horizontal sections may correspond to a greater amount of volume in the hair after the cut has been completed. The volume may, in some examples, be caused by the layering effect achieved by the C-cut technique. As shown, the horizontal sections may include a crown section **151**, a bottom crown section **152**, an upper midsection **153**, a lower midsection **154**, an upper occipital section **155**, and a lower occipital section **156**.

[0035] FIG. **4** illustrates an example in which one of the sections of hair have been released such that the hair from the released section can be cut using the C-cut technique. For example, after the hair has been separated into sections and secured with one or more fasteners, one section may be released by removing the fastener or fasteners **10**. As shown in FIG. **4**, back section **140** may be released. However, the order in which sections are released may be varied. For example, rather than releasing the back section **140** first, section **143**, section **145**, or section **150** may be released first. Further, the number of fasteners shown are exemplary and not intended to be limiting.

[0036] FIG. **7** illustrates an example C-configuration formed by the hand of the stylist. The C-configuration may be formed by curling one or more fingers **202** on the hand **200** down and curling a thumb **204** of the hand **200** up, leaving space **206** between the fingers **202** and the thumb **204**. Curling the fingers **202** down may include, for example, curling the fingers **202** towards thumb **204**. Curling the thumb **204** up may include, for example, curling the thumb **204** towards fingers **202**. Up and down may, therefore, depend on the perspective of the client and/or stylist.

Accordingly, the C-configuration may be formed by curling the fingers **202** and thumb **204** toward each other with a space **206** between the proximal ends of the fingers **202** and thumb **204**. The C-configuration may appear similar to the hand grabbing a substantially cylindrical object, such as a drinking glass. According to some examples, when the hand of the stylist is configured in the C-configuration, the hand of the stylist may appear similar to the American sign language sign for the

letter “c.” In some examples, the C-configuration may appear similar to an incomplete circle.

[0037] The hand positioned into the C-configuration may be used to gather small subsections of hair from the released section. For example, the hand may be laid upon a subsection of hair, allowing the ends of the hair within the subsection to poke through the opening created by the C-configuration. The size and number of subsections may be dependent upon the thickness, style, type, intended style, or the like. According to some examples, one subsection may overlap with another subsection. For example, the released portion of hair may be divided into a plurality of subsections. The subsections may be overlapping such that a portion of a first subsection may be included in a second subsection. The subsections within the section may be cut using the C-cut technique.

[0038] FIG. 8 illustrates the positioning of the hand of the stylist after forming the C-configuration. For purposes of clarity, FIG. 8 shows only the subsection of hair that is within the C-configuration, without illustrating the hair fastened in the surrounding sections or the released hair not in the C-configuration.

[0039] According to some examples, after a section of hair is released, the C-configuration may be formed around a subsection of released hair **108**. For example, the stylist may lay fingers of the hand **200** against the head **100** of the client, and a C-configuration may be formed around the subsection of hair **108** of the released section. The C-configuration may correspond to the C-configuration illustrated in FIG. 6. In some examples, the C-configuration may be formed at any point along the length of the released hair. Forming the C-configuration around the subsection of the released hair may position the subsection of released hair into the space **206** between the fingers **202** and the thumb **204**, gently cupping the hair **108** within the hand in the C-configuration. The loose ends of the cupped hair may then be trimmed in a circular motion using a cutting implement. The circular motion may correspond to the circular shape formed by the C-configuration.

[0040] The C-configuration of the hand **200** may minimize tension in the hand, thereby allowing the stylist to decrease the appearance of any harsh lines while trimming, as the ends of the hair are able to fall in their natural orientation. A loose hold on the hair promotes seamless integration of the curls, as the trimming is done in line with the natural fall and orientation of the hair. This minimizes any appearance of separation between the layers of hair. By utilizing the C-configuration, a loose cupping of the subsection of hair may be maintained.

[0041] In one example, the C-configuration may be formed near the scalp of the client and moved along the length of the subsection of hair within the C-configuration until the C-configuration formed by the hand of the stylist is located substantially at or near the loose end of the subsection hair. In some examples, the C-configuration may be formed anywhere along the length of the subsection of hair and moved along the length of the subsection of hair within the C-configuration until the C-configuration formed by the hand of the stylist is located substantially at or near the loose end of the subsection hair. Once the C-configuration is located at or near the loose end of the subsection of hair, a cutting implement may be used to cut and/or trim a portion of the loose ends from the subsection. The cutting implement may be moved in a circular motion. Cutting implements may include, but are not limited to, scissors, sheers, electric clippers, and buzzers. A portion of the trimmed ends of one subsection may be incorporated into the gathered hair of the next subsection to act as a guide for the length of hair to be trimmed away.

[0042] FIG. 9 illustrates an example motion of the cutting implement. For example, the subsection of hair within the C-configuration may be cut using a circular motion **212**. Cutting the subsection of hair using a circular motion **212** may cause the hair positioned within a center of the subsection of the hair **107** being cut shorter as compared to hair positioned closer to an exterior of the portion of the subsection of hair **106**. Specifically, the ends of the hair in the center of the gathered section **107** are made to be shorter than the ends of the hair at the edges of the gathered section **106**, creating a layered effect. In some examples, the layered effect may be a seamless layered effect. A seamless layered effect may be, for example, subtle layers in which the integration of the hair does

not create any clearly visible difference in length. In contrast, non-seamless layers may show visible breaks in length, creating a shelf-like appearance. The circular motion **212** may be iteratively repeated on the given subsection. For example, multiple cuts may be performed in the circular motion **212** and/or to form the circular motion **212**. For example, the cutting implement may perform a plurality of cuts following a clockwise or counter-clockwise pattern, thereby forming the circular motion **212**.

[0043] The circular cutting motion **212** may be repeated for any number of subsections within the released section. Utilizing the circular motion when cutting allows the loose ends of the hair to remain oriented in their natural direction, thus maintaining volume and shape. Circular cutting also allows seamless integration between the trimmed ends of the hair, preventing the appearance of harsh layers or shelves.

[0044] After the initial section of hair is released and cut using circular motions within the C-configuration, another section of hair may be released. The newly released section of hair may, similarly, be divided into subsections, held in a C-configuration, and cut using a circular motion as described above. This may be repeated until each of the sections have been cut.

[0045] While the order in which the sections are selected for cutting may vary, an example order may include, for example, where there are four sections as shown in FIG. 4, cutting the back section **140** first, proceeding to either side section (left **120** or right **130**), proceeding to the remaining side section (left **120** or right **130**), and concluding with the crown section **110**. In examples where there are six sections, such as in FIG. 5, the order may include cutting the center back section **150** first, proceeding to either back side section (left **143** or right **145**), proceeding to the remaining side section (left **143** or right **145**), proceeding to either crown side section (left **125** or right **135**), proceeding to the remaining crown side section (left **125** or right **135**), and concluding with the center crown section **115**.

[0046] According to some examples, the length of hair cut from each section may be determined based on the intended layered effect or desired volume to be achieved. For example, the length of hair selected may be cut to create a layered effect such that the hair **108** length is stacked to create shape and volume. To create a concave shape, the pieces of hair **108** located closer to the crown of the head **110** or **115** may be left be longer than those located closer to the back **140** or **150** near the occipital bone. By contrast, to create a voluminous convex shape, the inverse may be performed. Specifically, the pieces of hair **108** located closer to the crown of the head **110** or **115** may be left be shorter than those located closer to the back **140** or **150** near the occipital bone. For either intended shape, to create more volume, more layers may be added. Balance may be created by blending curls of the hair **108** from tighter to looser and more voluminous.

[0047] According to some examples, to create additional volume, balance, and shape, a rose technique may be used in conjunction with the C-cut technique. The rose technique, may include, for example, angling the cutting device inward, e.g., from the distal tip of the hair within the C-configuration inwards towards the skill or head of the individual. Each cut of hair during the circular motion of the C-cut technique may be done with the cutting device angled inwardly such that substantially triangular shaped portions of hair are cut from the distal ends of the section of hair within the C-configuration. The depth of the cut triangular potions of hair may be adjusted based on the intended volume and shape of the hair of the individual. In some examples, the angle the cutting device is held by the hair stylist is adjusted based on the intended volume and shape of the individual. Cutting triangular portions of hair are cut from the portions of hair within the C-configuration may be similar to creating flower, e.g., rose, petals within the portion of hair held within the C-configuration. The result of using the rose technique in conjunction with the C-cut technique may be a portion of hair in which some of the hair within the C-configuration is longer than others due to the angled nature of the cutting device. Having hair of different lengths can increase the volume, change the shape, and/or create balance for the individual.

[0048] FIG. 13A illustrates an example method for executing the C-cut technique. The steps

described do not have to be performed in the precise order presented. Rather, various operations can be handled in a different order or simultaneously, and operations may be added or omitted.

[0049] In block **402**, the hair of an individual may be separated into a plurality of sections. The hair of the individual may cover at least a portion of a head of the individual. The head may have a top with a crown, a right side, a left side, and a back side extending along an occipital bone. According to some examples, the number of sections of hair may be determined by the stylist. Considerations may include, but are not limited to, the desired hairstyle, the texture of the client's hair, and the thickness of the client's hair. For example, the plurality of sections may comprise four sections, six sections, etc. In examples where there are four sections, a first section of the four sections may be located on the crown, a second section of the four sections may be located on the right side, a third section of the four sections may be located on the left side, and a fourth section of the four sections may be located on the back side extending along the occipital bone.

[0050] In **404**, the plurality of sections may be secured with at least one fastener. For example, each section of the plurality of sections may be secured with at least one fastener.

[0051] The hair within each of the plurality of sections may be cut using a C-cut technique. The C-cut technique may include, for example, the steps in blocks **406-412**.

[0052] In block **406**, the at least one fastener from the one of the plurality of sections may be removed. Removing the at least one fastener may thereby release the hair within the one of the plurality of sections. In the example where there are four sections, the initial section selected may be the fourth section.

[0053] In block **408**, a portion of the hair within the one of the plurality of sections may be held within a first hand of the hairstylist. The first hand may be formed in a "C" shape, such as the C-configuration, as described above and herein. The portion of the hair may be held within the first hand such that ends of the portion of the hair extend through an opening created by the first hand.

[0054] Forming the "C" shape of the first hand of the hairstylist may include, for example, holding the first hand away from the body and parallel to a horizontal axis, grasping a portion of hair with the first hand, slightly flexing a thumb of the first hand in an upward motion relevant to the horizontal axis, slightly flexing an index finger of the first hand in a downward motion relevant to the horizontal axis determined by the floor, orienting the index finger towards the upturned thumb, such that the index finger does not make contact with the thumb and an opening is positioned between the index finger and the thumb, and slightly flexing a plurality of remaining fingers in an orientation mimicking the position of the index finger in the direction towards the thumb. Holding the portion of hair may include, for example, holding the portion of hair such that the ends of the portion of the hair that extend through the opening are held without pressure being to the hair by the first hand of the hairstylist.

[0055] In block **410**, the ends of the portion of hair extending through the opening may be cut in a circular motion such that the hair positioned within a center of the portion of the hair is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior portion of the hair. The hair may be cut by the hairstylist using a cutting implement held in a second hand.

[0056] In block **412**, the removing, holding, and cutting steps may be repeated throughout the released section until all of the hair within the released section has been trimmed.

[0057] According to some examples, each of the plurality of sections may be cut using the C-cut technique, e.g., blocks **406-412**. The order in which the sections are released may vary.

[0058] In examples where there are four sections, a length of hair cut from the strands of hair within the fourth section may be greater than a length of hair cut from the strands of hair within the first section. The strands of hair from each of the four sections may be cut to a respective length to create a layered effect between the sections.

[0059] In some examples, a prerequisite to cutting the hair may be that the hair is in a dry condition.

[0060] In another aspect, the present disclosure relates to a method for cutting curly hair utilizing a

pinch-cut technique. To execute this method, the stylist may first separate the hair **108** on the head **100** of the client into a plurality of sections. As shown in FIG. **1**, one configuration that may be used is four sections. Section. As shown in FIGS. **2-3**, the sections may consist of a crown portion **110**, a left side portion **120**, a right side portion **130**, and a back portion **140** located in the area of the occipital bone of the client's head **100**. The sections may be triangular portions. In some examples, the sections may have a shape substantially similar to a kite, trapezoid, quadrilateral, or the like. In some examples, one of the sections may have a first type of shape, another section may have another type of shape, or the like. Accordingly, the shapes of any one section may be the same or different than another section. To secure the sections of hair **108**, fasteners **10** may be used.

[0061] As shown in FIG. **5**, the stylist may alternatively separate the hair **108** on the head **100** of the client into a plurality of six sections. The sections may consist of a center crown section **115**, left side crown section **125**, a right side crown section **135**, a back left section **143**, a back right section **145**, and a back center section **150**. To secure the portions of hair **108** into sections, fasteners **10** may be used. As when creating four sections, the shape of the sections may be triangular, may have a shape substantially similar to a kite, trapezoid, quadrilateral, or the like. In some examples, one of the sections may have a first type of shape, another section may have another type of shape, or the like.

[0062] Once the hair has been separated into sections and secured with one or more fasteners one section may be released by removing the fastener or fasteners **10**. As one example, back section **140** may be released, as shown in FIG. **4**. However, the order in which sections or sections are released may be varied. The stylist may then position a hand into a pinch configuration, as depicted in FIG. **10**. The pinch configuration may be formed by curling a plurality of fingers **302** on the hand **300** in one direction, e.g., and curling a thumb **304** of the hand **300** up towards the fingers **202**, creating an overlap **306** between the fingers **302** and the thumb **304**.

[0063] FIG. **11** illustrates an example of securing a portion of hair using the pinch configuration. For example, after the stylist positions a hand into the pinch configuration, the stylist may then secure a portion of hair **108** between the fingers **302** and the thumb **304**, tightly holding the loose ends of the hair **108** within the fingers **302** and thumb **304** of the hand. The hand **300** may be positioned in the pinch configuration in such a way as to maximize tension in the hand, maintaining a tight hold of the ends of the hair **108**. The stylist may then use a cutting implement to trim a portion of the ends from the hair **108**. Cutting implements may include, but are not limited to, scissors, sheers, electric clippers, and buzzers.

[0064] FIG. **12** illustrates an example cutting motion when the hair is being held in the pinch configuration. For example, the cutting motion may include a circular motion **312**, such that hair positioned within a center of the portion of the hair is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior of the portion of the hair. Specifically, the ends of the hair in the center of the gathered section are made to be shorter than the ends of the hair at the edges of the gathered section, creating a layered effect.

[0065] This may then be repeated for the remaining hair within the section released from the first fastener.

[0066] The steps described supra, beginning with removing a fastener from another section of hair, may then be further repeated, until each of the four triangular sections have been cut.

[0067] To create further shape and volume the hair on the back of the client's hair may be separated into six horizontal sections. Referring to FIG. **6**, the horizontal sections may include a crown section **151**, a bottom crown section **152**, an upper midsection **153**, a lower midsection **154**, an upper occipital section **155**, and a lower occipital section **156**. The steps described supra, beginning with removing the fastener or fasteners from another section or section of hair **108**, may then be further repeated, until each of the sections or sections have been cut.

[0068] To determine the length of hair cut from each section, the length of hair selected may be cut to create a layered effect so that the hair **108** length is stacked to create shape and volume. To create

a concave shape or convex shape, the same method as described supra, may be employed.

[0069] According to some examples, to create additional volume, balance, and shape, a rose technique may be used in conjunction with the pinch cut technique. The rose technique, may include, for example, angling the cutting device inward, e.g., from the distal tip of the hair within the pinch inwards towards the skull or head of the individual. Each cut of hair during the circular motion of the pinch cut technique may be done with the cutting device angled inwardly such that substantially triangular shaped portions of hair are cut from the distal ends of the section of hair within the pinch. The depth of the cut triangular portions of hair may be adjusted based on the intended volume and shape of the hair of the individual. In some examples, the angle the cutting device is held by the hair stylist is adjusted based on the intended volume and shape of the individual. Cutting triangular portions of hair are cut from the portions of hair within the pinch may be similar to creating flower, e.g., rose, petals within the portion of hair held within the pinch. The result of using the rose technique in conjunction with the pinch cut technique may be a portion of hair in which some of the hair within the pinch is longer than others due to the angled nature of the cutting device. Having hair of different lengths can increase the volume, change the shape, and/or create balance for the individual.

[0070] FIG. 13B illustrates an example method for executing the pinch-cut technique. The steps described do not have to be performed in the precise order presented. Rather, various operations can be handled in a different order or simultaneously, and operations may be added or omitted.

[0071] In block 502, the hair of an individual may be separated into a plurality of sections. The hair of the individual may cover at least a portion of a head of the individual. The head may have a top with a crown, a right side, a left side, and a back side extending along an occipital bone. According to some examples, the number of sections of hair may be determined by the stylist. Considerations may include, but are not limited to, the desired hairstyle, the texture of the client's hair, and the thickness of the client's hair. For example, the plurality of sections may comprise four sections, six sections, etc. In examples where there are four sections, a first section of the four sections may be located on the crown, a second section of the four sections may be located on the right side, a third section of the four sections may be located on the left side, and a fourth section of the four sections may be located on the back side extending along the occipital bone.

[0072] In 504, the plurality of sections may be secured with at least one fastener. For example, each section of the plurality of sections may be secured with at least one fastener.

[0073] The hair within each of the plurality of sections may be cut using a C-cut technique. The C-cut technique may include, for example, the steps in blocks 506-512.

[0074] In block 506, the at least one fastener from the one of the plurality of sections may be removed. Removing the at least one fastener may thereby release the hair within the one of the plurality of sections. In the example where there are four sections, the initial section selected may be the fourth section.

[0075] In block 508, a first hand may be positioned into a pinch configuration, as described above and here, around a portion of the hair in the released section. The portion of hair may be held within the pinch configuration of the first hand such that ends of the portion of hair extend past the point of contact between a plurality of fingers and a thumb of the first hand.

[0076] Forming the pinch configuration of the first hand of the hairstylist may include, for example, curling a plurality of fingers on the first hand in one direction, e.g., and curling a thumb of the first hand up towards the fingers, creating an overlap between the fingers and the thumb.

[0077] In block 510, the ends of the portion of hair extending past the overlap formed by the first hand may be cut in a circular motion such that the hair positioned within a center of the portion of the hair is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior portion of the hair. The hair may be cut by the hairstylist using a cutting implement held in a second hand.

[0078] In block 512, the removing, holding, and cutting steps may be repeated throughout the released section until all of the hair within the released section has been trimmed.

[0079] According to some examples, each of the plurality of sections may be cut using the pinch cut technique, e.g., blocks **506-512**. The order in which the sections are released may vary.

[0080] In examples where there are four sections, a length of hair cut from the strands of hair within the fourth section may be greater than a length of hair cut from the strands of hair within the first section. The strands of hair from each of the four sections may be cut to a respective length to create a layered effect between the sections.

[0081] In some examples, a prerequisite to cutting the hair may be that the hair is in a dry condition.

[0082] For either method disclosed herein, the hair may remain in a dry condition throughout the entirety of the method.

Claims

1. A method for cutting hair by a hairstylist in order to create balance and volume, comprising the steps of: separating hair of an individual into a plurality of sections of hair, wherein the hair of the individual covers at least a portion of a head of the individual, the head having a top with a crown, a right side, a left side, and a back side extending along an occipital bone; securing the plurality of sections with at least one fastener; and cutting the hair within each of the plurality of sections using a C-cut technique, the C-cut technique comprising: removing the at least one fastener from one of the plurality of sections, thereby releasing the hair within the one of the plurality of sections; holding, within a first hand of the hairstylist formed in a “C” shape, a portion of the hair within the one of the plurality of sections, such that ends of the portion of the hair extend through an opening created by the first hand; cutting, by the hairstylist using a cutting implement held in a second hand, the ends of the portion of the hair extending through the opening in a circular motion such that hair positioned within a center of the portion of the hair is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior of the portion of the hair; and repeating the removing, holding, and cutting steps until all of the hair within the one of the plurality of sections is cut.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein each of the plurality of sections are cut using the C-cut technique.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of sections comprises four sections.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of sections comprises six sections.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the hair is in a dry condition prior to cutting.

6. The method of claim 3, wherein a first section of the four sections is located on the crown, a second section of the four sections is located on the right side, a third section of the four sections is located on the left side, and a fourth section of the four sections is located on the back side extending along the occipital bone.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein a length of hair cut from the hair within the fourth section is greater than a length of hair cut from the hair within the first section.

8. The method of claim 7, wherein the hair from each of the four sections are cut to a respective length to create a layered effect between the sections.

9. The method of claim 6, further comprising selecting an initial section of the plurality of sections, wherein the initial section is the fourth section.

10. The method of claim 1, wherein the “C” shape of the first hand of the hairstylist comprises: holding the first hand away from a body associated with the hair and parallel to a horizontal axis; grasping a portion of hair with the first hand; slightly flexing a thumb of the first hand in an upward motion relevant to the horizontal axis; slightly flexing an index finger of the first hand in a downward motion relevant to the horizontal axis, orienting the index finger towards the upturned thumb, such that the index finger does not make contact with the thumb and an opening is positioned between the index finger and the thumb; and slightly flexing a plurality of remaining fingers in an orientation mimicking the position of the index finger.

- 11.** The method of claim 10, wherein holding the portion of the hair includes holding the portion of hair such that the ends of the portion of the hair that extend through the opening are held without pressure being applied to the portion of hair by the first hand of the hairstylist.
- 12.** A method for cutting hair by a hairstylist in order to create balance and volume, comprising the steps of: separating hair of an individual into a plurality of sections of hair, wherein the hair of the individual covers a head of the individual, the head having a top with a crown, a right side, a left side, and a back side extending along an occipital bone; securing the hair within each of the sections with at least one fastener; and cutting the hair within each of the sections using a pinch method, the pinch method comprising: (i) removing the fasteners from one of the sections, thereby releasing the hair within the one of the plurality of sections; (ii) pinching, within a first hand of the hairstylist, a portion of hair within the one of the sections; (iii) adjusting a position of the first hand so that it is located near ends of the hair; (iv) cutting, by the hairstylist using a cutting implement held in a second hand, the ends of the hair extending through the first hand in a circular motion such that hair positioned within a center of the portion of the hair is cut shorter than hair positioned closer to an exterior of the portion of the hair; and (v) repeating steps (ii)-(iv) until all of the hair within the one of the sections is cut.
- 13.** The method of claim 12, wherein steps (i)-(v) are repeated until each of the plurality of sections have been cut.
- 14.** The method of claim 12, wherein the hair is in a dry condition prior to cutting.
- 15.** The method of claim 12, wherein the plurality of sections comprises four triangular sections.
- 16.** The method of claim 12, wherein the plurality of sections comprises six sections.
- 17.** The method of claim 15, wherein a first section of the four triangular sections is located on the crown, a second section of the four triangular sections is located on the right side, a third section of the four triangular sections is located on the left side, and a fourth section of the four triangular sections is located on the back side extending along the occipital bone.
- 18.** The method of claim 15, wherein a length of hair cut from the hair within the fourth section is greater than a length of hair cut from the hair within the first section.
- 19.** The method of claim 18, wherein the strands of hair from each of the four plurality of sections are cut to a respective length to create a layered effect between the sections.
- 20.** The method of claim 18, further comprising selecting an initial section of the plurality of sections, wherein the initial section is the fourth section.
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